

# Abigail R. Cormier

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## Academic Appointments

Assistant Professor, College of Business, Idaho State University, 2026–

## Education

Ph.D. University of Georgia, Economics, 2026

*Dissertation title: “Essays on the Economics of Health Shocks and Healthcare Access Disruptions”*

*Committee: Meghan Skira, Josh Kinsler, Jim Berry*

M.A. University of Georgia, Economics, 2023

B.S. Seton Hall University, Economics and Diplomacy and International Relations, 2019

## Affiliations

Georgia Institute of Technology

2025–Present

*Jimmy and Rosalynn Carter School of Public Policy*

*Health Economics and Policy Innovation Collaborative (HEPIC)*

## Research Fields

Health Economics, Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics

## Working Papers

### “The Causal Impact of Having Children with Special Health Care Needs” (Job Market Paper)

Abstract: Having a child with special health care needs may create additional time and financial costs for parents relative to having a child without special health care needs. Using data from the Panel Study of Income Dynamics (PSID) and dynamic difference-in-differences models, I examine how having a first child with special health care needs affects parental employment, hours worked, earnings, marital status, geographic mobility, and fertility in the U.S. Relative to mothers of firstborns without special health care needs, treated mothers reduce employment by 5.2 percentage points (5.7%), annual hours by 118 (6.8%), and full-time employment by 6.8 percentage points (9.6%) in the 0–3 years after birth. Treated fathers experience no additional labor-market effects relative to fathers of firstborns without special health care needs. I find no statistically significant effects on marriage or geographic mobility, but subsequent fertility declines by 13% for treated mothers and 11% for treated fathers by 7–10 years after the firstborn’s birth, driven by a decline in the probability of having three or more children.

### “The Effect of Behavioral Healthcare Access on Communities: Evidence from New Mexico”

Abstract: In 2013, New Mexico abruptly froze Medicaid payments to 15 of its largest behavioral healthcare organizations. Using matched two-way fixed-effects and synthetic difference-in-differences models, I estimate the effects of this payment freeze on the behavioral healthcare system and the communities these organizations served. In rural counties, the number of mental health offices fell by approximately 25%, and total employment at mental health offices fell by approximately 50%. Substance use disorder treatment admissions fell by approximately 64%. Among likely Medicaid-eligible adults aged 25–44, alcohol-induced deaths rose by approximately 50%, and drug overdose deaths rose by approximately 25%. These findings underscore the value of patient-provider relationships in behavioral healthcare and local access to care.

## Research in Progress

“Psychiatric Care Access and Adolescent Health Outcomes: Evidence from E.D. Boarding” with Angie Boy, and Kate Musen.

## Publications

“The Impact of Being Named the Top Party School on Peer Rankings and the Academic Profile of a University” with Austin Eggers, Pete Groothuis, Sean Mulholland, Kurt W. Rotthoff, and Aleksandar Tomic. *Applied Economics*, 2025, Volume 57, Issue 52, Pages 8662–8673.

“The Impact of Basketball Malfeasance on the University and its Rankings” with Austin Eggers, Pete Groothuis, and Kurt W. Rotthoff. *Applied Economics*, 2023, Volume 55, Issue 33, Pages 3902-3914.

“The Flutie and Anti-Flutie Effect: The Impact of Football Championships and Athletic Malfeasance on the University” with Austin Eggers, Pete Groothuis, and Kurt W. Rotthoff. *Journal of Sports Economics*, 2023, Volume 24, Issue 7, Pages 903-931.

“The Impact of Adoption Subsidies on Children Waiting for Adoption” with Kurt W. Rotthoff. *Empirical Economics Letters*, 2021, Volume 20, Issue 12, Pages 2057-2064.

## Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference Diversity Scholarship, 2026

Excellence in Teaching Award, 2026

Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, 2026

Graduate School Domestic Travel Grant, University of Georgia, 2023, 2024, 2025

Future Faculty Fellow, University of Georgia, 2024

American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference Program Chair Award for Health, Labor Markets, and the Economy, 2024

Don Lavoie Scholarship, The Fund for American Studies: The American Institute on Political and Economic Systems—Prague, 2019

Summer Research Fellow, Department of Economics, Seton Hall University, 2019

## Past Academic Employment

Summer Graduate Assistant to Dr. Chris Cornwell, University of Georgia, 2022–2026

Graduate Assistant, University of Georgia, 2021–2026

## Teaching Experience

### *Instructor of Record*

Intro to Data Science for Business and Economics (Undergraduate), University of Georgia, Spring 2025

### *Coordinating Graduate Assistant*

Intro to Data Science for Business and Economics (Undergraduate), University of Georgia, Fall 2024, Spring 2024, Fall 2023, Spring 2023, Fall 2022

### *Teaching Assistant*

Intro to Data Science for Business and Economics (Undergraduate), University of Georgia, Spring 2026, Fall 2025, Spring 2022

Intermediate Microeconomics (Undergraduate), University of Georgia, Spring 2022

Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate), University of Georgia, Fall 2021

## Conference and Seminar Presentations

2026

Georgia Institute of Technology Health Economics and Policy Innovation Collaborative (HEPIC) Collaborators Conference, American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference, Journal of Economics Teaching Symposium on Economics Teaching, Southern Economic Association Meetings (upcoming)

2025

American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference, University of Alabama at Birmingham AI Economics Summit, Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management Fall Research Conference, Southern Economic Association Meetings

2024

American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference, Western Economics Association International Conference, Journal of Economics Teaching Symposium on Economics Teaching, Southern Economic Association Meetings, Atlanta/Athens Health Economics Research Conference

2023

Western Carolina University (research presentation to undergraduate students)

## Conference Discussions

American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference (2026), American Society of Health Economists Annual Conference (2025), Western Economics Association International Conference (2024)

## Referee Activity

*Harvard Data Science Review, Economic Development and Cultural Change, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*

## References

### **Meghan Skira**

Sara and Dan Boyd Professor  
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Terry College of Business  
University of Georgia  
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### **Josh Kinsler**

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### **Jim Berry**

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